

Also, make sure each column contains similar items—for example, include text in one column and numeric values in a separate column.

- m Remove all automatic totals: Don't worry—the PivotTable report will calculate the subtotals and grand totals for you.
- m If you plan to add more data later, create a named range: Then, when you create the 'PivotTable' report, make sure to specify the named range. That way, whenever you add more source data, you can update the 'PivotTable' report to include the new data.
- m If you want to include filtered data, use the 'Advanced Filter' command: On the 'Data' menu, point to 'Filter', click 'Advanced Filter', and then click 'Copy' to another location. This extracts the filtered data to another worksheet location, so you can use it in your 'PivotTable' report. Don't filter the data in place by using the 'AutoFilter' command, or by using the 'Filter' the list, in-place option of the 'Advanced Filter' command. This merely changes your view of the data (not the data itself), and the 'PivotTable' report will include all the data in the list.

3.7.2.2 Prepare data from an external data source

There are a few things to consider in preparing your external data:

- m Install the necessary tools and drivers: You're probably all ready to go—just make sure you've installed 'Microsoft Query' and the appropriate open database connectivity (ODBC) drivers or data source drivers you need. (If you're not sure how to do this, type install 'Microsoft Query' in the Office Assistant or on the 'Answer Wizard' tab in the Excel Help window, click 'Search' and then click 'What you need to retrieve external data'). Then, when you create a 'PivotTable' report by using the 'PivotTable' and 'PivotChart Wizard', you'll use 'Microsoft Query' to actually retrieve the external data.
- m If applicable, get more details on OLAP source data: If you're retrieving source data from an OLAP database or cube file, you can find out more about the OLAP features of Excel by typing create a 'PivotTable' report from OLAP source data in the Office